

CHANDIGARH POLICE HACKATHON 2026

TECHNICAL & PARTICIPATION GUIDELINES

Applicable to PS-1, PS-3 and PS-4

1. MANDATORY PHYSICAL PRESENCE

- Every registered team member must be physically present at the venue on 8 September 2026 for the complete designated 12-hour hackathon period.
- Remote participation, remote coding or contribution from outside the venue is **strictly prohibited**.
- Every member must remain available for development, testing, presentation and jury interaction.
- Teams selected for the Grand Finale on 9 September 2026 must have all registered members physically present.
- Absence of any member without prior approval may lead to **penalization/disqualification**.

2. PS-1: HARDWARE / BIOCHEMICAL PROTOTYPE

- Actual narcotics, psychotropic substances or controlled/illicit materials are strictly prohibited.
- Only safe, legal, synthetic, simulated or harmless control samples/reagents may be used.
- Pre-purchased components such as sensors, microcontrollers, SBCs, optical components and 3D-printed enclosures are permitted.
- Core integration, programming, calibration, signal processing and system development must be demonstrated during the hackathon.
- Unsafe electrical systems, exposed high-voltage AC and hazardous materials are prohibited.

3. PS-3: DARK WEB / CYBER INTELLIGENCE

- All cyber/Dark Web experimentation must be conducted in **isolated VMs/sandboxed environments**.
- Unauthorized scanning, exploitation, intrusion or attacks on any live system/network are strictly prohibited.
- Actual stolen credentials, PII, illicit transactions, malware or contraband content must not be downloaded, stored or displayed.
- Use synthetic, mock or legally obtained and sanitized OSINT data for demonstrations.
- Maintain version-controlled repositories with meaningful development history.

4. PS-4: AI / MEDIA FORENSICS

- Use of **ChatGPT, Copilot, Cursor and similar AI tools is permitted** for coding assistance, debugging and boilerplate generation.
- Every team member must be able to **explain the code, architecture, models and methodology** used in the solution.
- **Thin-wrapper solutions** relying primarily on commercial AI/deepfake-detection APIs are not acceptable.
- Teams should demonstrate substantial technical work such as feature extraction, forensic analysis, custom pipelines, model adaptation/fine-tuning or ensemble methods.
- Pre-trained/open-weight models may be used, but their **source, license and modifications must be disclosed**.

5. DATA, APIs & INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

- Use only **legal, authorized, public/open-source or self-generated datasets**.
- Third-party APIs may be used for supporting functions but **must be disclosed**.
- The core problem statement must not be outsourced to a proprietary black-box service.
- Respect all applicable privacy, copyright and licensing requirements.

6. LIVE DEMONSTRATION & EVALUATION

- **Live demonstration before the jury is mandatory.**
- Teams must be able to demonstrate their working system/prototype and explain its technical implementation.
- Pre-recorded videos may be used only as contingency evidence in case of genuine hardware/network failure.
- The jury/Organizing Committee may reject or penalize solutions that violate these guidelines.

IMPORTANT

All teams are required to comply with these instructions. Any violation, misrepresentation, unauthorized activity, unsafe practice or inability to explain the submitted solution may result in score reduction or immediate disqualification.

Issued by:

Organizing Committee, Chandigarh Police Hackathon 2026

University Institute of Engineering and Technology (UIET), Panjab University